

Decifact

The Missing Governance Layer

COMPARABILITY · BEFORE · COORDINATION

THE UNRESOLVED SEAM

Most AI governance work focuses on a single system: Does this agent behave correctly? Is this decision auditable? Does this output comply with policy?

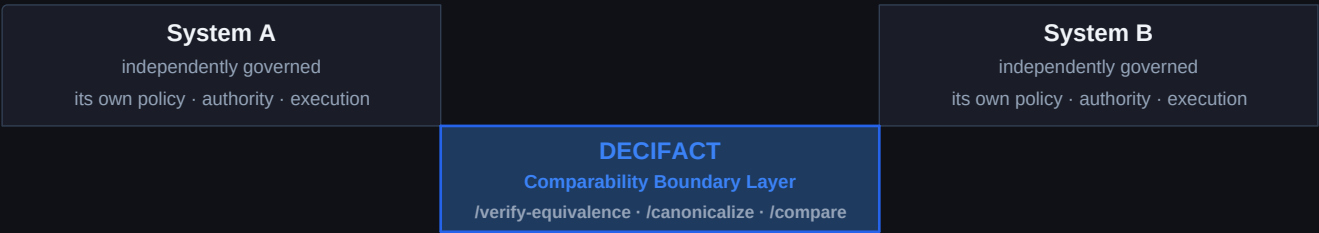
These are necessary questions. But they leave a deeper problem unaddressed.

When independently governed systems begin coordinating — sharing decisions, delegating authority, producing joint consequences — a prior question must be answered first:

Were the governance conditions across these systems ever established as comparable before their outputs began creating shared institutional dependencies?

This is not a runtime enforcement problem. It is a precondition problem. Without comparability verification at this layer, operational success can be mistaken for structural resilience. The gap widens unnoticed until the cost of closure is prohibitive.

WHERE DECIFACT SITS



Decifact does not govern either system. It does not transfer authority between them. It exposes whether their decisions share the invariant boundary required for meaningful coordination — before coordination begins.

WHAT DECIFACT PROVIDES

- Deterministic equivalence verification
- Canonical boundary inspection
- Cross-runtime fracture detection
- Invariant mismatch evidence
- Semantic divergence location
- Independent of both systems — no shared write domain

WHAT DECIFACT IS NOT

- Not a runtime policy enforcer
- Not an audit log or dashboard
- Not a governance platform
- Not an orchestration layer
- Not inside either system
- Not a compliance checklist

CONSTITUTIONAL INVARIANT

"The canonical boundary must exist before layer instantiation."
— Guardian Constitutional Specification

Without an established comparability substrate, deployment success deepens dependency while structural resilience remains unmeasured. Each system onboarded accelerates lock-in that precondition recovery would need to unwind.

SCOPE

Concern	Status
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Decision equivalence verification	✓ This layer
Cross-runtime fracture inspection	✓ This layer
Canonical boundary canonicalization	✓ This layer
Decision acceptance (validity in context)	Guardian v0.3
Runtime policy enforcement	Different layer
Governance of either system	Out of scope